

Equipment Checkout System

System Requirements

Version 1.1 — July 13, 2026

Status: Draft — pending client sign-off on v1.1 additions

Previous version: v1.0 — June 25, 2026

Changes from v1.0 are noted with ★ throughout this document.

1. Project Info

- Timeline: November due date
- Post-launch support included
- Budget: \$2,000–\$3,000 initial + ~\$30/month ongoing

2. User Types

2.1 Students

- Tiers: Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced
- Tier progression: automatic move-up; admins/workers can also move students manually
- Login restricted to school email only
- Can have one active reservation per location; concurrent reservations at different locations are permitted
- ★ Reservations must be made a minimum of 2 weeks before the pickup date
- ★ Students must book both a pickup time and a return/drop-off time when creating a reservation
- ★ Maximum checkout period: 4 days

2.2 Workers

- Cannot check out their own reservations
- Cannot add new workers
- Can update item quantity
- Can check out student reservations
- Can view dashboard reservations
- Cannot add locations
- Cannot add new items
- Faculty count as workers
- ★ Can create same-day reservations
- ★ Can add or remove items from an in-progress (active) reservation

2.3 Admins

- Can check out their own items
- Can promote workers to admin and demote back to worker

- Can change item access levels for students
- Can switch item quality status (green / yellow / red)
- Can add/edit items and locations
- ★ Can edit nearly all reservation fields:
 - Change pickup time, including same-day (bypasses 2-week student rule)
 - Change the checkout student on a reservation
 - Add or remove items from a reservation
 - Remove fees from a student account
- ★ Can add notes to a student's profile
- ★ Can issue strikes against a student (3-strike rule — see Section 5)
- ★ Can block a student's checkout privileges

2.4 Professors

- Access to recurring reservations
- Short-time checkout: access only to their course material
- Full-time: access to all material
- Part-time: access to all material

3. Items & Kits

3.1 Item Attributes

- Name, brand/model, purchase price, picture, location, description, categories (for good search)
- Price visible to students for pre-production budgeting
- Status indicator (green/yellow/red) with notes for damaged equipment
- Editable by workers and admins

3.2 Kits

- Workers and admins can group items into kits manually
- Kits are suggestions, not required bundles
- If a full kit is checked out → kit shows as unavailable
- If one item from a kit is taken and no duplicates exist → kit shows as unavailable
- If the taken item has duplicates in stock → kit stays available
- Items can be swapped in/out of a kit at checkout

3.3 Tier Editing (Admin)

- Edit name, price, specifications, optional YouTube link, tier assignment

4. Reservations

4.1 Basics

- Reserve items, locations, and kits
- ★ Location must be selected early in the reservation flow (first or second step)
- A single reservation can only contain items from one location; students needing gear from multiple locations must create a separate reservation for each
- ★ Details captured: location, date, pickup time, return/drop-off time, items
- ★ Calendar view is based on the school's academic calendar; holidays and non-operating days are blocked (no pickups or drop-offs on those days)
- Auto-save so students don't lose work
- Track previous, current, and future reservations
- Block reservations when items are unavailable
- Recurring reservations for professors/classes

4.2 Checkout Duration & Late Fees

- ★ Maximum checkout period: 4 days from pickup
- ★ Return time must be booked at the time of reservation
- ★ Late fees accrue at \$5/item/day after the return due date
- Escalation path: \$5 → \$10 → \$25 → rental privileges suspended (admin manages manually)
- Admins can remove fees at their discretion

4.3 Approval Workflow

- Request-based; reservation only confirmed after approval
- Reservations above a certain limit require approval
- After approval: only workers and admins can edit
- After denial: students can edit and resubmit; denial reason is shown
- Admins notified of new requests via email
- Students notified via email

4.4 Holds & Waitlist

- Items on hold while awaiting approval
- Waitlist available for held items

4.5 Pickup Windows

- Reservations with 25+ items: checkout between 2–5 PM, check-in between 8–10 AM
- Reservations under 25 items: checkout between 10 AM–5 PM
- If student is 15+ minutes late → reservation deleted (manual)
- ★ Holidays and non-operating days (per school academic calendar) are fully blocked — no pickups or drop-offs

4.6 Capstone Projects ★

- ★ Student can flag a reservation as a capstone project
- ★ If flagged, a pre-meeting scheduling step is unlocked before pickup
- ★ Student schedules a pre-meeting with staff to review equipment needs
- ★ Pickup cannot be confirmed until the pre-meeting is completed and marked done
- ★ Capstone reservations receive scheduling priority

4.7 Crew / Group Reservations ★

- ★ A producer (lead student) can create a group reservation
- ★ Producer assigns roles and specific items to individual crew members (e.g., sound, camera, lighting)
- ★ Each crew member receives a notification that they are part of a crew reservation
- ★ Both the producer and crew members can:
 - Edit their own pickup time (not the date)
 - Remove items from their portion of the reservation (not add)
- ★ Producer retains full control of the overall reservation
- ★ System tracks who personally checked out what across the crew

5. Student Notes & Strike System ★

- ★ Admins can add notes to any student's profile at any time
- ★ Notes are used to document behavioral or equipment concerns

- ★ A 3-strike system is in place; strikes are issued at admin discretion for:
 - Damaging equipment
 - Consistently late pickups or drop-offs
 - In-class behavioral issues
- ★ After 3 strikes, the admin may block the student's checkout privileges
- ★ Admin can view a student's full note and strike history

6. Checkout Process

6.1 Core Flow

- Student makes a reservation and it gets approved
- Both worker and student use a checklist on their phones (responsive web)
- Both parties tap “approved/got it” to complete checkout
- Whoever taps the checkout button is responsible for the material
- System tracks who checked out what

6.2 Crew / Group Checkout ★

- ★ Producer creates group reservation and assigns items to crew members
- ★ Each crew member checks out only their designated items
- ★ Multiple checkout forms exist under one producer reservation, one per designated student
- ★ System tracks who took what individually

6.3 Capstone Pre-Meeting ★

- ★ If a reservation is flagged as a capstone project, a pre-meeting must be scheduled and completed before checkout
- ★ Pre-meeting is used to review equipment needs and confirm the kit
- ★ Worker or admin marks the pre-meeting as completed to unlock the checkout step

7. Returns & Status Checks

- Status check — verify equipment condition; if changed, add comments and report it; Red = not available
- Status report — checklist completed by worker
- Damage alert — pop-up notification to student that quality dropped; admin reaches out
- Student hold — student placed on hold until resolved with admin
- Missing tag — worker can tag items as missing if not returned or lost

7.1 Late / Missing Item Policy

- Late items marked as missing
- First late return: one warning
- ★ Late fees: \$5/item/day, escalating — \$5 → \$10 → \$25 → rental privileges suspended
- Admin manually manages fines and student hold status
- Admin can remove fees at their discretion

8. Search & Filters

- Strong search engine
- Categories and filters
- Consistent item naming (current system's biggest pain point)
- Prices visible to students for pre-production budgeting

9. Reporting

- Available item count
- Items currently in use
- Reservation tracking: popularity, timing of reservations
- Capstone projects get scheduling priority
- AI assistant for querying data — nice to have, not required

10. Post-Launch

- Customer support after completion

- Ability to add more locations over time
- Scalable item management

11. Open Items (Pending Client Confirmation)

Question	Context
Should Workers see the Approval Queue?	Currently admin-only. If workers are front-line staff, they may need visibility.
Should Workers manage the Waitlist?	Currently admin-only (same front-line consideration as above).
How are professor recurring reservations configured?	Does the professor set the pattern directly, or does an admin configure it on their behalf?
Who can schedule the capstone pre-meeting?	Can the student initiate the pre-meeting request, or does a worker/admin schedule it after the capstone flag is set?
Strike notification — is the student told?	When a strike is issued, does the student receive an automated notification, or is it an internal admin record only?